13 Colouring in the pattern made it look much less stark but there were still quite large areas where the bleach had not removed the staining in the wood. To cover these areas I decided to texture and paint the background to the design. Texturing was done by 'stippling' with a 2.5mm ball cutter in a high speed micro drill

14 It took another four hours or so to cover the whole background, working carefully around the coloured design. On end grain, the cutter's friction scorched the wood leaving black indentations but on side grain there was no scorching, presumably because the wood was softer. In this instance it didn't really matter either way because I intended to paint over it anyway

15 With the texturing finished, it was all painted over with gold varnish, using a fine artist's brush. This varnish looked good, went on easily, covered discolouration well and dried quickly. Again, it's a lengthy job painting round the coloured design

16 The bowl was almost completed now, albeit nothing like the bowl I'd originally intended. The next job was to remount it and remove the dovetailed spigot from the foot. The centre mark made centring it on my vacuum chuck straightforward

17 The previous soaking in water and subsequent drying had distorted the bowl a little and it was no longer perfectly circular, so I left the tailstock in place to provide additional support. Fortunately, the distortion of the foot region was small and it still turned reasonably true. The dovetail spigot was reduced to a small stub without any problem

18 With the tailstock removed, the vacuum was good enough to hold the bowl securely while the stub was gently turned away with several fine cuts

19 With the base finished and sanded to 400 grit, a part of the sap staining could still be seen but I decided to leave the bottom unchanged to show the true colour of the timber and the stains that ran through it

20 With all the turning completed the bowl was sprayed with three coats of acrylic spray and it was finished at last. It was completely different from how I'd originally planned it to be but, I think, successful for all that ●

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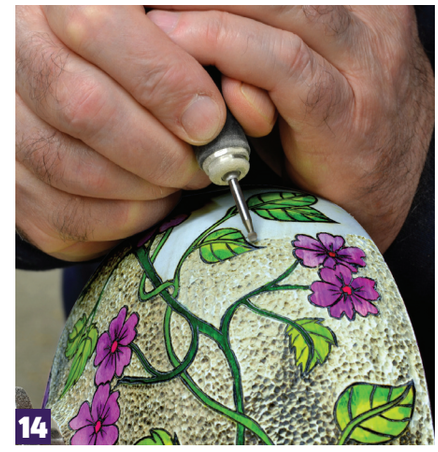
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